

Pre-Arrival Report (PAR) changes

In an amendment to the Biosecurity Regulation 2016 which came into force on 27 February 2026, pre-arrival reports must only be provided in writing (electronically). Reports must be lodged into the non-commercial vessel pre-arrival report (PAR) web portal by non-commercial vessel operators. Refer to the Import Industry advice notice [364-2025: Action Required: New pre-arrival reporting obligations for non-commercial vessels and aircraft \(non-scheduled flights\)](#).

Pre-Arrival Reporting requirements for non-commercial vessels

Under Australia's Biosecurity Act 2015 all non-commercial vessel owners, vessel operators and returning Australians must provide a pre-arrival report (PAR) prior to arrival in Australian waters.

The department has made it easy for non-commercial vessel operators to report their arrival in Australian waters with the online non-commercial vessel Pre-Arrival Report (PAR) web portal. A PAR must be submitted no earlier than 90 days and no later than 12 hours before arriving in Australian territory.

The Australian Border Force (ABF) also has legislated mandatory requirements for pre-arrival reporting. Refer to the ABF Yachts and pleasure craft webpages for further information: Yachts and pleasure craft (abf.gov.au). [Let us know you're coming](#).

Resources

The following checklist, video and guides provide more information.

Our video provides an overview of the non-commercial vessel PAR, its purpose and the pre-arrival process..

Video transcript

Are you thinking about cruising to Australia?

Are you a non-commercial vessel operator?

If you are intending to arrive in an Australian territory to visit or you are importing a non-commercial vessel, then you have a responsibility to comply with Australia's Biosecurity Act 2015 and Biosecurity Regulations 2016.

Under Australian laws, all vessels arriving in Australian territory, including yachts, superyachts and cruisers, are subject to biosecurity control and must provide pre-arrival report information before arriving in Australian territory.

So, what's changing?

The department has improved our pre-arrival reporting process for non-commercial vessel operators with the introduction of an electronic pre-arrival report or PAR. From the 1st of December 2023 all non-commercial vessels arriving in Australian territory must submit a PAR.

The PAR is submitted through the department's web portal, and it will be uploaded into the department's Maritime and Aircraft Reporting System called MARS.

MARS is the online web portal that is currently used by the commercial shipping industry.

So, what is in the new non-commercial vessels PAR?

There are questions about the number of travellers, the vessel travel history, the vessel's timber components, plans for Australian port visits, the estimated length of stay and if there is waste or any plants, insects, animals or hitchhiker animals or birds on board.

Each of your answers will give the department a heads up about your arrival and what biosecurity risks, if any, might be on board.

Biosecurity officers will be notified of vessel arrivals through MARS.

Then, they will prepare for the arrival using the new MARS pre-arrival report or PAR provided by the vessel operator and engage with vessel operators and commence a biosecurity risk assessment.

What is important is to remember to always:

- notify the department 90 days to 12 hours before your arrival
- understand the biosecurity status document or BSD (it will be emailed to the vessel operator

and provides the biosecurity directions and conditions for the voyage)

- keep a copy of the BSD on board for the duration of your time in Australia
- inform the department of any change in circumstances by emailing the National Maritime Centre or the vessel contacts, which can be found on the non-commercial vessel page of the department's website.

Want to know more?

View the Vessels webpage for information on Australia's biosecurity reporting obligations and responsibilities.

Subscribe to the department's Facebook, X and Instagram sites.

Quick reference checklist and guides

Download

If you have difficulty accessing these files, [contact us](#) for help.

If you are visiting, returning to, or [importing a non-commercial vessel](#), the operator is responsible for complying with [Australia's Biosecurity Act 2015](#) and [Biosecurity Regulation 2016](#).

Biosecurity measures ensure a low level of risk of harmful pests and diseases entering and establishing in Australia and enables the appropriate management of pests and diseases that pose a risk to the Australian environment and agricultural industries.

All vessels arriving from an international destination, or that have come in contact with other international vessels, must:

- give notice of impending arrival 90 days to no less than 12 hours before arrival, known as a Pre-Arrival Report (PAR).
- enter Australia through a [first point of entry \(FPOE\) for non-commercial vessels](#), which has been confirmed on the Biosecurity Status Document you will receive from the department once you lodge your PAR.
- advise the department of any changes to your voyage plans by editing the PAR, using the link that you received by email following submission of your PAR.
- be granted pratique by the department before crew or passengers disembark the vessel or any goods are unloaded (including baggage or waste).
- undergo an inspection of the vessel by a biosecurity officer. Vessels with timber components have additional requirements.
- manage any identified biosecurity risk as directed by a biosecurity officer.

All vessel operators are required to submit separate and additional Pre-Arrival Reports for travel between mainland Australia and the territories of Christmas, Cocos (Keeling) and Norfolk Islands. Refer to [What is Australian territory and external territory?](#)

All non-commercial vessels arriving in Australia are required by law to give notice, that is, provide a pre-arrival report (PAR), to the department of impending arrival:

- before the vessel departs the last (international) port but no earlier than 90 days before arrival in Australian territory OR
- at least 12 hours before arrival into the first point of entry in Australian territory
OR
- as specified by a biosecurity officer.

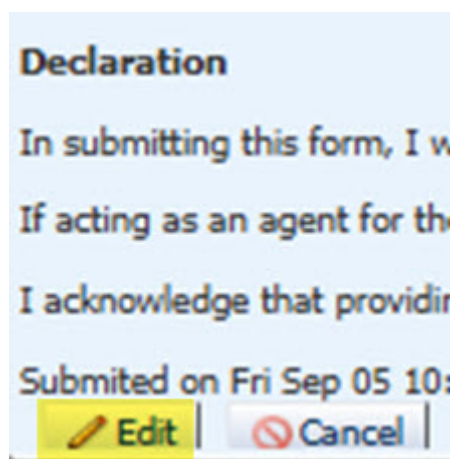
The non-commercial vessel PAR streamlines inspection processes at the border, providing a single source of information for assessing biosecurity risks for associated with arriving vessels. Report your impending arrival into Australian territory by using this link to the non-commercial vessel PAR portal: <https://online.agriculture.gov.au/MARSWeb/faces/public/NCVPARRegistration.jsf>

Once the PAR has been submitted through the portal, it will automatically upload into the department's Maritime and Aircraft Reporting System (MARS). Biosecurity officers, at the port nominated in the PAR, will be notified of the vessel's impending arrival and engage with the vessel operator to prepare for their arrival and undertake necessary biosecurity risk assessment.

Biosecurity officers rely on your PAR to know when and where your vessel will arrive. You are legally required to notify the department of any changes to your arrival location. If you don't update the PAR or notify the department of your voyage arrival change officers may not be prepared for your arrival. This may result in clearance delays.

It is an offence to arrive at a port that has not been approved by the department.

You must choose a port of arrival and plan to arrive there. If your voyage plans change and you divert to a different port, amend the PAR by clicking edit on the email choose EDIT at the bottom right of your PAR, see below image.



Alternatively advise in writing to the biosecurity officers at the relevant port. All seaport contacts are on the [Vessel Contacts](#) webpage.

Not arriving at the specific port detailed in your PAR and associated Biosecurity Status Document is an offence. It will save you time and money if our biosecurity officers know you are arriving and are prepared to meet you.

Specific health risks are posed by international travellers, passengers and crew, arriving in Australia. These risks could have a devastating effect on the Australian community and economy. Vessel operators must report any human health issues for all the travellers and crew on board.

Contact biosecurity officers: www.agriculture.gov.au/about/contact/phone/vessel or read the webpage for more information: [Human health](#).

All vessels are subject to pratique when entering Australian territorial waters, which is approximately 12 nautical miles (nm) from the Australian coastline.

Under the Biosecurity Act, pratique is permission for 'any person to disembark from or embark onto' a vessel or 'anything to be unloaded from or loaded onto' a vessel.

Non-commercial vessels are subject to the negative pratique process and will not be granted pratique until a biosecurity officer has assessed the human health risks associated with the vessel. The granting of pratique confirms that the human health risk of all the travellers on board the vessel can be identified and managed and allows the vessel to be disembarked or unloaded.

To go ashore prior to pratique being granted is an offence under the Biosecurity Act.

Contact with other vessels in port prior to biosecurity assessment is also prohibited.

Read all about Pratique at [Vessel Pratique](#), including a diagram for non-commercial vessels.

Australia has strict laws relating to the importation and/or possession of certain goods to minimise the risk of the introduction of exotic pests and diseases into Australia.

- Vessel operators must declare and present all food/provisions, plant material, animal products and live animals for inspection on arrival in Australian territory.
- Consume organic provisions prior to arriving in Australian territory. Any remaining provisions must be managed as biosecurity waste, double-bagged for disposal.

Some goods may be allowed into Australian territory if they are accompanied by a valid import permit issued by the department. Some goods may require treatment to manage the biosecurity risk. Other goods, such as live animals, that pose pest and disease risks are not permitted to be imported.

The page [Travelling or sending goods to Australia](#) provides more information. For detailed information on whether a commodity that can be brought into Australia, refer to the Biosecurity Import Conditions system ([BICON](#)).

Biosecurity officers will direct arriving vessels to arrive at a specified First Point of Entry (FPOE) port, determined as a port for arrival for the non-commercial 'class' of vessel.

Non-commercial vessels may only arrive at Australian ports if the port has been determined as a First Point of Entry (FPOE) for non-commercial vessels under s229 of the Biosecurity Act 2015. FPOE ports determined for non-commercial vessel arrivals are listed below or refer to the web [FPOE ports list](#).

- Northern Territory (NT) – Darwin
- Queensland (QLD) – Brisbane, Bundaberg, Cairns, Coral Sea Marina Airlie Beach, Gladstone, Gold Coast Broadwater, Mackay, Townsville and Port Kennedy (Thursday Island and Horn Island)
- New South Wales (NSW) – Coffs Harbour, Newcastle, Sydney
- Western Australia (WA) – Fremantle
- Tasmania (TAS) – Hobart, Launceston (Bell Bay)
- External Territories – Christmas Island, Cocos (Keeling) Islands, Norfolk Island.

For contacts of all the department's biosecurity port office locations, refer to the [Vessel Contacts](#) webpage.

It is an offence for a vessel subject to biosecurity control to moor and/or unload goods at a port in Australian territory that is not a first point of entry, unless the Director of Biosecurity (or delegate) has given (prior) permission, s245 of the Biosecurity Act 2015.

International vessels must comply with the permissions and conditions contained in the relevant FPOE determinations. Each determination lists:

- permissions for particular classes of vessel that may berth, or goods that may be unloaded at the port
- biosecurity entry points (BEPs) within the port
- any conditions associated with the port as a first point of entry.

Read more about [FPOE Determinations](#).

BEPs are designated areas within the port where specific classes of vessels must arrive or goods must be unloaded. This is so their biosecurity risks can be appropriately managed. Different classes of vessels and goods require different infrastructure and procedures to manage the risks associated with their arrival.

If a BEP has been designated in a first point of entry determination for a specific class of vessel or goods, then all vessels or goods that are part of that class must be brought to a BEP as soon as practicable when arriving into the port.

Non-commercial vessels may only arrive at some Australian ports from an international destination (the last port). See [Non-commercial vessel arrival biosecurity reporting – Where in Australian territory can NCV operators arrive?](#)

Australian territory ports that are not approved for non-commercial vessel arrivals are classed as non-first points of entry. These ports are not assessed against the FPOE Biosecurity Standards for non-commercial vessels and may not have appropriate infrastructure or processes in place to manage biosecurity risks.

To arrive at one of these ports, vessel operators must apply and receive prior permission to moor the vessel or unload goods at a non-first point of entry determined for that particular class of vessel or good.

How non-commercial vessels can request permission to moor/unload cargo at a non-first point of entry.

For non-commercial vessels to berth and/or unload goods at a non-first point of entry, submit an application and receive written authorisation. Be aware when submitting a request that:

- Applications should be submitted at least 10 days before arrival into Australian territory.
- Applications are evaluated on a case-by-case basis. Approval is not guaranteed.
- Written notice will be provided to the vessel operator where permission is either granted or not granted under section 247(2) of the Act for the vessel to moor, or under section 146 for permission to unload goods.

It is preferable to consult with the department early in the planning process to minimise impacts to itinerary plans for non-first point applications. Submit non-first point of entry requests to conveyance.maritime@aff.gov.au.

Vessel operators are required to submit separate and additional pre-arrival reports for each voyage:

- between mainland Australia and the territories of Christmas, Cocos (Keeling) and Norfolk Islands.
- between the Australian mainland and the Australian External Territories (AETNCAT), and between the external territories.

AETNCAT locations are:

- Ashmore Reef and Cartier Island
- Coral Sea Island Territory including Willis Island
- Macdonald Islands
- Heard Island
- Australian Antarctic Territory.

Examples: A vessel visiting an AETNCAT location from the mainland will be leaving Australian waters. A vessel operator returning to a mainland port from an AETNCAT location will be considered a new voyage and is required to lodge a new PAR.

Except for travel between mainland Australian and Norfolk Island, non-commercial vessels will be subject to negative pratique requirements.

Pratique does not apply to travel to and from the Australian mainland and Norfolk Island

Vessels travelling to and from Norfolk Island and the mainland are exempt from pratique requirements as per the Biosecurity (Human Health) Regulation 2016. This will be confirmed in the Biosecurity Status Document you receive from the department once the PAR has been lodged.

Australian external territories not considered Australian Territory (AETNCAT)

Refer to the webpage [Biosecurity legislation and the Australian territory](#) for further details.

The department administers Ship Sanitation Certification (SSC) requirements on behalf of the Australian Government, [Department of Health and Aged Care](#).

Ship Sanitation Control Exemption Certificates and Ship Sanitation Control Certificates are issued in accordance with Article 39 of the [International Health Regulations \(2005\) Third Edition \(IHR\)](#).

Certification is aimed at controlling the spread of international listed human diseases by controlling any vectors of these diseases that could potentially be carried on a vessel.

Under Part 5 (section 12) of the [Biosecurity \(Human Health\) Regulation 2016](#), non-commercial vessels are exempt from the ship sanitation certification scheme. Chartered superyachts are considered commercial vessels, not non-commercial vessels. These vessels have shipping agents to manage arrival and reporting.

Australia will therefore not undertake Ship Sanitation inspections or issue Ship Sanitation certificates for private non-commercial vessels (sailboats/yachts).

Ballast water is water taken on board by vessels to maintain stability and trim. Ballast water can contain thousands of aquatic microbes, plants and animals, which can be spread across the globe as the vessel releases ballast water. Unmanaged ballast water released in Australian ports could potentially introduce a range of invasive marine species.

The Biosecurity Act and other related delegated legislation, collectively prescribe how ballast water should be managed within Australian territory.

The Australian Ballast Water Management Requirements explain how to comply with the legislation while operating a vessel in Australian waters. In general, vessels have the following obligations:

- manage ballast water prior to arrival in Australian seas, and between Australian ports
- carry a ballast water management plan, ballast water management certificate, and maintain ballast water records.

Read about [Australian ballast water management requirements](#).

Non-commercial vessels arriving in Australian territory must submit a non-commercial vessel pre-arrival report (PAR) which includes questions relating to the biofouling management practices on the vessel.

The PAR responses help us manage biosecurity risks associated with biofouling on non-commercial vessels.

Refer to the [Biofouling – non-commercial vessel webpage](#) for more information.

Hitchhiker pests are pests that can ‘hitch a ride’ to Australian territory from another country within shipping containers, imported goods, packaging material and other forms of human-assisted transportation.

Australia is currently free of some of the world’s most serious hitchhiker pests that threaten our industries, economy, environment and way of life. This is because we have a strong biosecurity system that works to prevent pests entering and establishing here.

However, the risk of hitchhiker pests entering Australia is increasing due to climate change, intensification of agriculture, increased movement of people and products, and supply chain complexities. Pests are spreading around the world and are being found in increasing numbers on or within vessels, sea containers and imported goods.

Hitchhiker pests include beetles, snails, bugs, ants, termites and bees.

Read about hitchhiker pests and how you can help to protect Australian territory from the threat of [hitchhiker pests](#).

Non-commercial vessel operators must submit pre-arrival reports in writing (electronically). The [Biosecurity Amendment \(2025 Measures No. 1\) Regulations 2025](#) is in force from 27 February 2026.

The department will apply compliance and enforcement provisions to conveyances that do not meet reporting requirements.

Reminder to vessel masters and shipping agents:

- Changes in circumstances during a visit or voyage to Australian territory, particularly of the human health of travellers, must be reported to a biosecurity officer as soon as practicable,
- A failure to report accurately or comply with a requirement under the [Biosecurity Act 2015](#) may result in penalties, including infringement notices, civil penalties, or criminal prosecutions.

The [Biosecurity Regulation 2016](#) defines a non-commercial vessel as a vessel that is used, or is intended to be used, wholly for recreational purposes (whether or not crew are employed on the vessel).

Section 193 of the Biosecurity Act 2015 states that:

- the operator of the vessel must give a report if it is intended that the vessel is entering Australian territory.
- the report must include information prescribed in the Biosecurity Regulation 2016.

Section 48 (6) (b) of the [Biosecurity Regulation 2016](#) states the pre-arrival reporting timeframe for reporting arrival into Australian territory:

All non-commercial vessels arriving in Australia are required by law to (report) give notice of impending arrival:

- Before the vessel departs the last (international) port but no earlier than 90 days before arrival in Australian territory
- at least 12 hours before arrival into the First Point of Entry in Australian territory
- or as specified by a biosecurity officer.

Section 48 (2) of the Biosecurity Regulation 2016 states that the following detail must be provided in the pre-arrival report (abbreviated):

- information identifying the vessel
- the name of the person in charge of the vessel and all other travellers
- the intended voyage and past 12-month history
- the shipping agent/s (if any) engaged to manage the voyage
- any intended traveller disembarkations
- any goods on board and previous history
- vessel cleaning and biofouling management history
- live plants or plants that have died on the voyage
- human health of the travellers
- any animals or insects on board
- waste management arrangements.

Australia's border protection is a partnership of Australian and international law enforcement and intelligence agencies.

Biosecurity

Our biosecurity system protects agriculture, forestry and fisheries export industries. Australia has over 60 000 kilometres of coastline offering a variety of pathways for exotic pests, weeds and diseases to enter the country.

Our department screens, inspects and clears millions of vessels, aircraft, mail parcels, cargo containers, plants and animals, and of course people. Using x-ray machines, pre- and post-entry quarantine and surveillance programs and detector dogs, our border security is our first line of defence for protecting our environment and social amenity.

Australian Border Force (ABF)

The Australian Border Force (ABF) protects Australia's border and enables legitimate travel and trade. They safeguard the border from people who seek to commit immigration fraud or threaten Australia's safety and security. That is regulating unlawful citizens, seizing prohibited goods such as drug imports, weapons, tobacco, images and wildlife while examining travellers, baggage and mail.

Our department requires all non-commercial vessel operators to submit a Pre-Arrival Report (PAR), no earlier than 90 days and no less than 12 hours before arriving in Australian territory. This isn't, however, the only Australian Government arrival report that non-commercial vessel operators must submit.

The Australian Border Force (ABF) also has legislated requirements for pre-arrival reporting.

Whether you are a returning resident, migrant or a visitor, the Australian Border Force (ABF) has a corresponding Small Craft Arrival Report that must be submitted 96 – 12 hours before you arrive in Australian territory. Refer to the ABF Yachts and pleasure craft webpages: Yachts and pleasure craft (abf.gov.au).

Notify ABF of arrival by emailing: Yacht Report yachtreport@homeaffairs.gov.au, phoning: ABF +61 2 6246 1325 or fax +61 2 6275 5078.

In addition to being an offence to leave Australia without ABF clearance, it is also an offence to go ashore without receiving approval from the Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry and the Australian Border Force.

An overview of the inspection process

All non-commercial vessels arriving in Australia are required by law to (report) give notice of impending arrival:

- Before the vessel departs the last (international) port but no earlier than 90 days before arrival in Australian territory
- at least 12 hours before arrival into the First Point of Entry in Australian territory
- or as specified by a biosecurity officer.

For ports determined as first points of entry for non-commercial vessels, refer to the above information: Where in Australia can non-commercial vessel operators arrive?

Following the report of impending arrival, each vessel should receive some advice prior to arrival about the specific Australian territory port approved for arrival and biosecurity requirements. See the biosecurity Vessel Contacts for the key biosecurity port office contact details across Australia to notify arrival or contact for advice.

Vessel operators, after the submission of the non-commercial vessel PAR through the web portal, will receive emailed Biosecurity Status Documents (BSDs) for the voyage.

BSDs:

- are the single source of information for biosecurity directions and advice to vessel operators (masters), and shipping agents, for each voyage.
- are auto-generated in MARS and emailed to the vessel operator, and any nominated agent. BSDs are version controlled to reflect any reported changes to directions or status occurring throughout a voyage.
- detail the department's directions for the voyage including berthing conditions, pratique, goods (including animals and hitchhikers), timber inspection and treatment directions.
- use a traffic light system as a visual cue to alert the master and shipping agents regarding the vessel status and any associated directions or advice issued by the department.
- Biosecurity officers will confirm vessel operator email addresses at the on-arrival inspection.

A quick reference guide to Understanding the MARS Biosecurity Status Document (BSD) is available at this link: [Quick Reference Guide: Understanding the BSD](#).

For an efficient biosecurity inspection, ensure the following actions are undertaken:

- Read the non-commercial webpage to know about Australia's biosecurity rules and inform all travellers on board of these requirements
- report pending arrival: vessel details, arrival port and ETA between 90 days to 12 hours before arrival in Australian territory including information on
 - the human health of all persons on board
 - or any changes in voyage or other circumstances onboard.
- alert the department to the presence of and contain/confine pets or animals on board.

- secure the vessel in such a way that prevents excessive movement during the inspection.
- ensure all areas of the vessel are accessible for inspection, particularly timber surfaces.
- move panels, personal effects and other equipment from lockers and cupboards as directed.
- mattresses/cushions from lounges/beds and any wall or floor coverings must allow adequate access for inspection
- Have organic provisions e.g. fresh fruit, meat, eggs and other waste bagged on arrival for removal.
- have documentation available regarding timber components, such as sailing history, any refits or treatments.

For importing a vessel or information on import requirements for individual commodities and goods refer to BICON.

BICON houses the biosecurity import conditions database for more than 20,000 plants, animals, minerals and biological products. It will help determine what import conditions exist and if an import permit is required.

Refer to bicon.agriculture.gov.au as well as the [Importing to Australia](#) webpage for more information about BICON.

All non-commercial vessels that enter 12-NM of Australian coastline are considered an import; this applies to vessel under own power (sailing) or being imported as goods onboard another vessel.

Vessel operators must pre-arrival report at least 12 hours before arrival into the First Point of Entry in Australian territory and refer to the [BICON case Imported Sea-going vessels](#), for import conditions. Biosecurity officers will assess and manage the biosecurity risk.

Vessel operators should advise if the vessel will be in Australian territory for less than or longer than 12 months. Importing a vessel indicates whether the vessel will be permanently based in Australian territory.

An interview with the operator provides a biosecurity officer with the opportunity to verify the biosecurity status of the vessel, people and any animals onboard, and confirm what was declared on the PAR and any changes that may have occurred since PAR submission.

The inspection and risk assessment tasks conducted are critical risk controls designed to prevent exotic diseases, pests and listed human diseases (LHD) becoming established in Australian territory.

The common biosecurity risks associated with arriving yachts and superyachts are timber pests, food, plant material, animals and/or human health concerns.

Inspections will only be undertaken in safe conditions, during daylight hours and within normal ordinary hours. More than one inspection may be required to resolve any identified biosecurity risks. Additional charges will be incurred for inspections occurring on the weekend or public holidays or outside of normal operational hours.

At arrival at the First Point of Entry, a biosecurity officer will assess health, grant pratique, board the vessel to ask questions, assess documents and conduct a physical inspection of the vessel to manage any

biosecurity risk. The interview and inspection includes the assessment of the health of all persons on board and the inspection of:

- personal effects/articles
- timber components of the vessel and any history of damage or refits
- kitchen facilities and storerooms foodstuffs, personal effects, souvenirs
- sanitation and waste
- hull, anchors, chains and other ancillary gear
- water collection/storage containers including standing water, which is a vector for mosquito larvae.

The biosecurity officer will ask to view all relevant documentation, such as information related to timber components.

Where a specific timber inspection is required and cannot be undertaken on arrival the vessel remains subject to biosecurity control. The vessel operator must arrange for a timber inspection within 14 days of arrival in Australian territory.

Where no biosecurity concerns are detected during the inspection, the biosecurity officer may release the vessel from biosecurity control.

Once the biosecurity officer has completed the physical inspection of the vessel, a post inspection interview is conducted with the operator to discuss any biosecurity issues identified in the vessel inspection.

To manage any biosecurity risks, the biosecurity officer may undertake or direct the operator to undertake certain directions and/or treatments, including (but not exclusive to):

- isolation, treatment and/or export of [live animals](#) on board
- management of [plants](#) on board
- management of biosecurity waste such as plants, food and animal waste etc
- removal of all biosecurity risk materials from a vessel so it can be released from biosecurity control where the biosecurity risk is managed and the vessel is able to freely travel around Australian territory
- other treatments as directed.

Where biosecurity concerns are detected, the biosecurity officer can take any of the following actions:

- seek further advice from departmental technical experts or other authoritative body
- refer concerns such as human health issues to other relevant Australian Government agencies
- use alternative detection methods (e.g. detector dog or device for termites)
- direct the vessel to undergo remedial action via approved methods, such as timber treatment
- direct the vessel to a particular place
- direct the vessel to be imported as a good

- where the officer considers the volume of any biosecurity waste to be large, the operator must use a service provider operating under an approved agreement (AA) for the collection, storage, transportation and appropriate disposal of biosecurity waste.
 - The AA service provider must remove the waste in accordance with the procedures stated in their approved arrangement with the department.

Vessels may also be subject to verification inspections by a biosecurity officer on succeeding days at the first point of entry and subsequent port/s of call to ensure continued compliance with the directions issued by biosecurity officers.

Waste is any item (goods) that has been rejected for entry into Australia. In some cases, the items may require treatment before being allowed, while in other cases the items are marked for immediate disposal due to the biosecurity hazard risk they represent.

Waste includes:

- packing material
- food waste
- by-products created from the treatment of imported goods
- biohazard quarantine items
- goods not meeting import requirements during the biosecurity inspections.

All vessels with timber components entering Australia must be inspected for timber pests, whether the vessel is sailed in, itinerant, a returning Australian vessel or imported as cargo. When a vessel is sailed in, the inspection of timber components is likely to be included as part of the arrival inspection.

Where the inspection of timber components cannot be performed on arrival at the FPOE, the inspection must be completed within 14 days of arrival.

It is the vessel operator's responsibility to make arrangements for this inspection to occur and to ensure the vessel is presented at the port of arrival within the 14 days. The vessel will continue to be subject to biosecurity control, including restrictions, until the timber inspection has been performed and a biosecurity officer advises that the vessel is released from biosecurity control. Refer to [Importing vessels with timber components](#).

Animals arriving in Australian ports or transiting within Australian waters onboard a non-commercial vessel such as a yacht, without a valid import permit, are not permitted.

Animals that arrive in Australian territory without a valid import permit will be treated as illegally imported animals. Refer to the [Animals on Vessels – non-commercial vessels](#) webpage and the [Import Industry Advice Notice 32-2023](#), or contact the department via telephone on 1800 900 090 (+61 3 8318 6700 outside Australia).

Biosecurity risks must be mitigated to an acceptable level for release from biosecurity control. Release from biosecurity control will not be completed where continuance of biosecurity control has been

requested or is required, such as a high risk food, illegal live animal on board, pest risk or where the vessel requires a specific timber inspection or follow-up inspection.

The department charges for activities it undertakes to protect Australia's biosecurity. Where a vessel is inspected at the first port of call, an arrival levy and a fee-for-service, the time taken to inspect the vessel, will be charged.

- Inspection services for yachts and superyachts are payable at the time of inspection. Credit card payments can be made by calling Accounts Receivable on 1800 647 531 or visit the [How to Pay](#) page.
- Cash cannot not be accepted by biosecurity officers.
- The department service fees are invoiced, normally through a customs broker for yachts imported as goods. Some broker fees must be paid prior to the inspection taking place.

The first point of entry arrival inspection is covered by standard vessel fees. Where biosecurity issues are detected, vessel owners will be charged at fee-for-service rates and any additional charges relating to the timber inspection or mitigation of any other biosecurity risks.

Additional fees will be charged for inspections occurring on the weekend or public holidays or outside of normal operational hours.

A full list of fees associated with vessel biosecurity services are set out in the department's [charging guidelines](#).

The vessel owner will be charged by marina operators for the disposal of biosecurity waste with supervision fees charged by biosecurity officers. These are additional charges to the biosecurity fees charged for vessel inspection, management and release from biosecurity control.

Under section 532 of the Biosecurity Act, a person is liable to a civil penalty for false or misleading information, or omission of any matter, or thing, without which the information is misleading.

Failure to comply with a requirement under the Act may result in penalties, including infringement notices, civil penalties or criminal prosecutions.

Department obligations

Client service standards ensure we are meeting your expectations and are delivering our services within agreed time frames. For non-commercial vessel inspections, the standards are:

- If you are arriving at a port where we have a permanent biosecurity officer presence (which is a mandatory requirement), we will provide an initial inspection, including granting pratique, within 1 business day from you advising us of your arrival.
- There may be delays during periods of increased arrivals, such as regattas and rallies.

Your obligations

- Be available and have your vessel ready for inspection when our biosecurity officers arrive.

- Send us all relevant documents before the inspection.

Measure of success

- 95% of inspections to be provided within our service standard.

You can find the service standards at: [Client service standards](#)

Reports on performance

- The department's [Annual reports](#) detail our activities and performance.

All vessels, yachts, leisure craft, private superyachts and cruisers, arriving in Australian territory from international waters are subject to biosecurity control. At the First Point of Entry (first port of arrival) in Australian territory, biosecurity officers conduct inspections on every arriving non-commercial vessel.

Note: Inspections are not required for vessels in the following scenarios;

- The vessel is either:
 - not subject to biosecurity control, or
 - has been released from biosecurity control.

Or

- The vessel travelled beyond the 12 nautical mile limit and:
 - departed from an Australian port or location

and

- returned to Australia without any interaction with:
 - international vessels or conveyances, or persons,
 - international goods or animals,

and

- the vessel did not arrive at or moor in any international port or location during its journey outside the 12 nautical mile limit.

Biosecurity officers may question operators regarding their status and voyage details.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/aircraft-vessels-military/vessels/non-commercial-vessels>